

TK705STi uses a ToF sensor and a built-in camera to understand how far it is placed from the wall, and corrects the orientation and focus.

Once that's all set, you can watch the content you like. Over long-term use, I didn't hear any noise. If you touch around the ventilation area, you'd find it a little warm. So, it handles heat and noise quite well. So, you can comfortably watch movies, series or even play games at 4K 60 fps. The rated input lag is 5ms, which should feel instant and ideal for fast-paced games. You also get ALLM (Auto Low Latency Mode) to prioritise speed over graphics. Overall, this should be suitable for casual console gamers.

AUDIOVISUAL QUALITY

The BenQ TK705STi is branded as a 4K short-throw projector. It uses a 0.47-inch DLP projection chip/system and possibly pixel shifting to achieve a UHD (3840×2160) resolution. It can project up to a 150-inch image from a range of 2 meters (about 6 feet). You can zoom out for a smaller-sized image, too. At smaller sizes, the picture looks sharper. The larger sizes, like 100 or 150 inches, are immersive, but sharpness and contrast fall slightly short of a good 4K TV.

It supports brightness of 3,000 ANSI lumens, and in a well-lit room, projected on an off-white wall, the image looks washed out. It is visible, but for something worth enjoying, you'll have to turn off the light in the room.

There is out-of-the-box support for 4K HDR playback on Netflix. You can watch HDR content on formats like HDR10, HDR10+ and HLG. The sharpness, details and contrast don't match the 4K TV I have, but it is still respectable. I had a fine experience bingeing the last few episodes of *Fallout SO2* on Amazon Prime Video. This was an HDR10+ content, and the difference was noticeable. But in the underwater scene in *Mission: Impossible- Final Reckoning*, where Tom Cruise's char-



acter tries to escape from the falling submarine, the colours look fine, but I could not clearly make out the edges of the submarine, and there were some instances of banding in a few areas.

I was watching all content in Cinema mode, which has the closest to natural colours, among the available presets. This BenQ projector features 98% coverage of the Rec 709 gamut, which is the standard colour space for most streaming content.

Like in TVs, here too, I had MEMC turned off as I don't like the TV-serial-like smoothness in movies and other content I watch. If you like that, you can enable it in the expert display settings.

As for audio, the dual 8W speakers are loud enough for room use, and dialogue comes through clearly. The bass, however, is only average. If you have a soundbar, it is better to connect it via HDMI to get fuller, uncompressed audio. Like picture modes, here too, I preferred the Cinema mode.

SHOULD YOU BUY THE BENQ TK705STI?

The BenQ TK705STi projector is not trying to replace every TV. It is trying to solve a specific problem, getting a very large screen in a space where a traditional setup is not practical. Whether it makes sense depends on how you plan to use it.

If your situation is similar to mine, wherein you need a personal screen in the bedroom, but don't want a TV, a projector starts to make sense. You can place the BenQ projector on a table, project a 100-inch screen from a short distance, and have a private viewing setup without installing a large TV. When you don't want to use it, you can easily move it to a different spot.

While using the TK705STi, its Google TV interface, native Netflix support, and smooth day-to-day performance make it easy to use. You get 4K visuals with natural colours, good brightness, and decent detail at typical viewing distances.

So, the BenQ TK705STi is a loaded projector and the best you can get for the asking price of Rs 2,25,000. It is worth considering if you understand what it is designed for. It doesn't beat a TV on all fronts. Instead, it offers a kind of convenience; a large, immersive screen in spaces where that would otherwise be difficult to achieve.

—G. S. Vasan

SPECIFICATIONS

Brightness: 3000 ANSI lumens | Resolution: 4K UHD | Aspect Ratio: 16:9 | Contrast Ratio: 600,000:1 | Input Lag: 5 ms | Ports: 2x HDMI 2.1, 1x USB Type A, USB Type C, 1x 12V Trigger 3.5mm Jack | Speaker: 2x 8W | Power Supply: AC 100 to 240 V, 50/60 Hz | Power Consumption: 25-W | Connectivity: Bluetooth 5.2, Wi-Fi | Weight: 3.8 kg

CONTACT

Company: BenQ | Phone: 1800-419-9979 | Email: Service-In@BenQ.com | Website: <https://www.benq.com/en-in/support.html>

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